

follow/nofollow - This tells the engines what to do with links on your pages: whether they should trust and “follow” your links.

## URL STRUCTURE:

The URL structure of your website pages is one sure shot indicator of how optimised your website is for a search engine. One mantra you must not ignore at any cost is that hyphens used in a URL give it a whole different meaning than when underscores are used. An example would be when you google “brown leather couch”. In case you’d like your page to feature on the search results, naming your URL “<http://yourdomain.com/brown-leather-couches>” is worlds apart from naming it “[http://yourdomain.com/brown\\_leather\\_couches](http://yourdomain.com/brown_leather_couches)”. The presence of underscores would cause your URL to be indexed as “brownleathercouches”, which is entirely irrelevant to what you MEANT to provide. In a similar vein, using capital letters changes the meaning of your URL, so it’s generally best to avoid them. Also, make sure your URL is 100% readable by humans. If you are shown two entries:

<http://yourdomain.com/brown-leather-couch>

<http://yourdomain.com/main.php?=956564=t65=?>

It’s pretty obvious you’ll be more inclined to click on the first link rather than the second.

Another cardinal rule of naming URL structures is that your URL length must not exceed 2048 characters. In such a scenario, ignoring this means Internet Explorer won’t be able to load the page. Moreover, your folder and hence, URL structure, should indicate the importance of your content. In case you’ve created a nested URL structure for more important content, it’s best to change it to give more importance to the main content.

Having a search feature on your site generates dynamic and duplicate URLs to the same content, depending on the user’s filtered search. Block extra dynamic URLs pointing to the canonical (statically named) URL by using a robots.txt. Also, you can help Google index your page better by telling its robots that a particular page has an alternative mobile link, in case you’ve created your content in such a way. In Google’s words, “On the desktop page, add a special link rel=”alternate” tag pointing to the corresponding mobile URL. This helps Googlebot discover the location of your site’s mobile pages”.

When you’ve made changes to a URL, remember that you are technically removing a page that has been indexed by Google. Remember to add a 301 redirect from your old URL to your new in case of such a change.